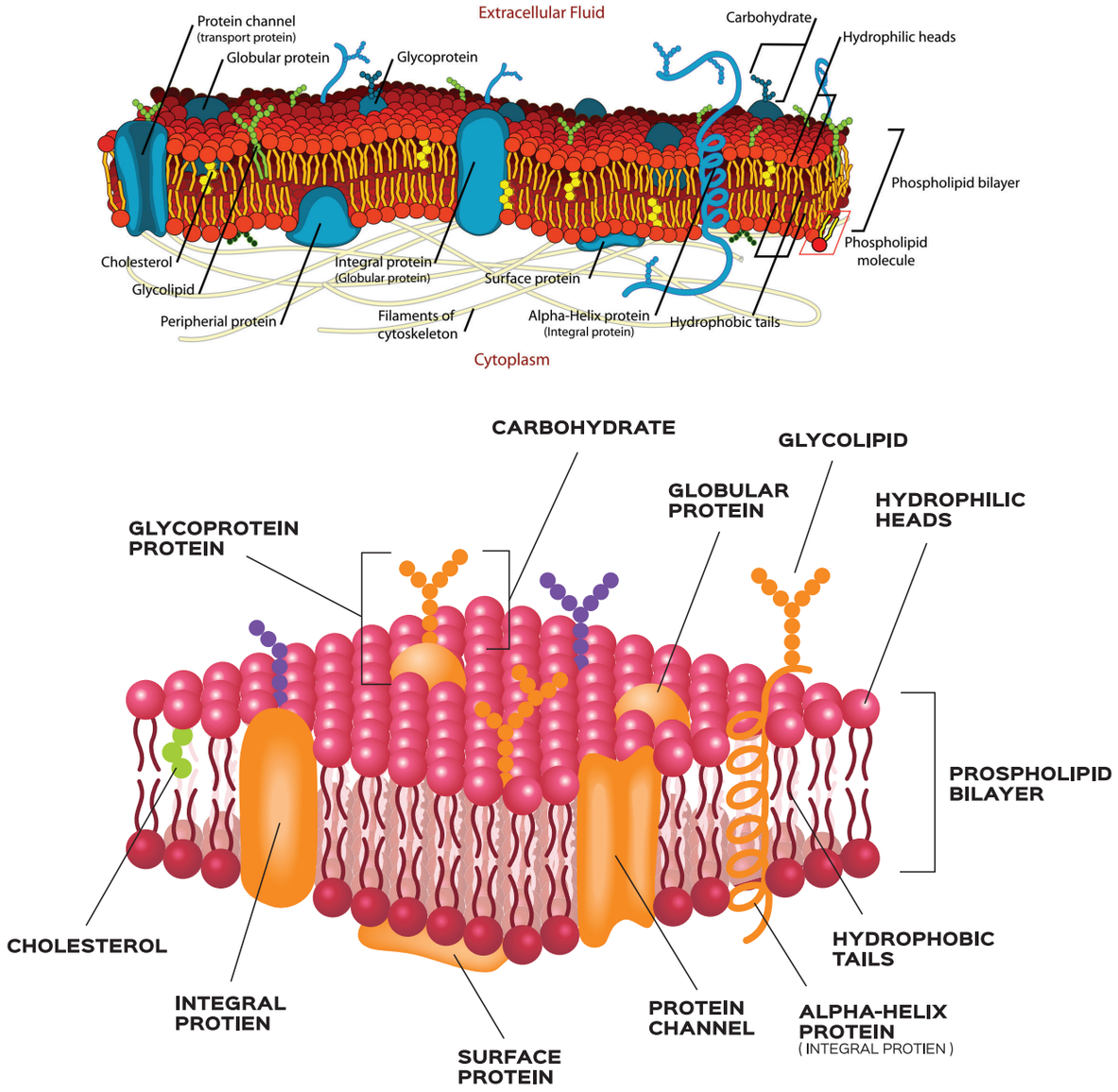


Figure 1.3 A schematic diagram of plasma membrane

The plasma membrane separates the contents of the cell from the external environment. In the unicellular organism, the 'external environment' is the exterior world; for a multicellular organism, it is both the exterior world outside the organism as well as the interior world created by other cells. For this process of division of a pre-existing cell, a cell must carry within it the information for reproducing all its components. The form of this information is a single type of genetic material, DNA, which codes for all the proteins of the cell.

Functions of cell membrane

- It serves to keep all the component parts of the cell together in one place.
- It regulates the continuous movement of substances into and out of the cell.

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